

Individualist anarchism

Individualist anarchism puts personal freedom and the rights of the individual above the authority of the state, nation, class or any hierarchical structure. The earliest strand of anarchism, it is in effect an assertion of individual sovereignty. William Godwin, the first to develop what is known as philosophical anarchism, was an early influence. He argued that government corrupts society, because it encourages dependency and ignorance, and imposes upon an individual's right to 'private judgement'. Godwin also dismissed various cooperative and rule-determined practices, such as law, private property and marriage, as mental enslavement. Subsequently, Max Stirner promoted a more extreme view arguing for what he described as unions of 'egoists', based entirely on self-interest. As individualist anarchism spread, Benjamin Tucker suggested each individual should enjoy the maximum liberty, compatible with others. Individualist anarchists tend to reject revolution as a means of bringing about change, arguing that it can result in new hierarchies.

Liberty

• NOT THE DAUGHTER BUT THE MOTHER OF ORDER. •

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"For always in these eyes, O Liberty!"

*"Whence that high light which the world is proud,
And though thou sleep'st, as well is not as thou?"*

JOHN HAY.

PRIEST—KING—BURGER—SERP.

I.

FRANK—AND HIS CARRIAGE WIFE.

Kings! Henry, kneel! Strip off thy coat of mail;

In penitential garment kiss the feet

Which spurn thee: thou should'st deem it penance meet

For God's Anointed, who has dared to rail

At him whom men as Christ's vice-great hail.

Feasting with us, who deem this no trifling

With Christian love, thy penance complete.

For now, here earth's most angry geyser

Reels! rebel, kneel! Authority is one,

One God is myth, and man with joy shall

See o'er the granite form God's Holy Son.

Whom church triumphs hail this welcome hour

Whom monarchs, bachelors, and low 'scabbs her power

Not dream to share but thou more graciously take.

Hypocrisy.

In the Editor of Liberty:

There is great temptation for loud men of principle to anathematize thus all kinds of politicians, without the necessary distinction of degrees, although, when the proposition is stated abstractively, it is evident that principles are as worthless without accommodations of policy, as is policy without principle. Besides different degrees of enlightenment, equally compatible with sincerity, we are apt to assume different social data. For Anarchism, by immediate entrance of police

forces, it is evident, for example, that a city like New York must be inappropriate. Its social data is intelligence with a fair normal average of character, such as is found in many rural settlements and small towns, with the material means of production and distribution. No living tissue excludes physiology, but the physiologist will not select a parasitic growth nor the seat of an abscess for illustrations of organic law. Anarchism, or the evolution of spontaneities, is predicable of normal humanity, not of monstrosities.

Invest X, or invest Macdonald, with real daktarship over New York or Boston, and it is probable that either would

great principle with all the force that is in us. I take my stand on this single ground. There is no right to compel others to serve out *our* interests, or to accept our opinions. There is but one rightful use of force, that of restraining force, that of restraining forcible aggressions upon the free rights of thinking, acting, and possessing that belong to us all.

ALGERNON HARRISON.

Judges the Dangerous Criminals.

(Ed. W. Chamberlain in John Swinton's Paper.)

I have in my possession the deposition of Andrew H. Farley, who for eight years acted as public prosecutor in the United States Circuit Court in New York city, where Judge Bondert, during that time, presided. Mr. Farley testifies:

Q. Don't you think that most sentences in that case were just as valuable as those of the defendant's counsel? A. No, not in any Government case, because we don't put a man on trial until we have two-thirds or nine-tenths the best of the case before we start, and the lawyer on the other side has harder work. It is easier for the district attorney. You have all the power of the Government of the United States behind you, and you have all the detectives you want, who

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